CREST NICHOLSON

WARRANTY GUIDE

WARRANTY

At Crest Nicholson, we are dedicated to excellence in construction and while we take every step to achieve this, we recognise that sometimes you may encounter problems in your new home.

This booklet outlines some frequently asked questions, explains how the warranty period works and defines which items are our responsibility and which are those of the home owner.

Please read this booklet carefully. If you have any questions or require clarification of any points, please contact your Divisional Customer Service Team for advice.

All contact information can be found under the ‘Contact Us’ tab on our website: www.crestnicholson.com

WHAT IS A WARRANTY?

Your new home is provided to you with a new home warranty and it protects your home against the unlikely event of a significant structural defect.

The first two years of this warranty is known as the initial warranty period and Crest Nicholson provides cover during this time for any defects that are caused as a result of defective workmanship or materials.

The warranty doesn't cover:

- Any works that you have undertaken in the home yourself or extensions and alterations that have been added
- Damage caused by storms
- Damaged due to lack of maintenance
- Cosmetic damage
- Any problems caused by condensation or shrinkage

Cover in years three to ten will be provided by your warranty provider, who will cover you for structural defects in this period. Full details and the cover certificate should be provided by your solicitor.

WHAT IS A DEFECT?

Certain items in your home are your responsibility as the home owner and you'll find a table of warranty FAQ's in this document outlining who is responsible for various fixtures, fittings and systems. Please refer to this before reporting an item as a defect.

BOOKED APPOINTMENTS

If you have agreed to an appointment with Crest Nicholson or one of our contractors, please ensure you are available for it or make and communicate suitable access arrangements.

We understand that unforeseen circumstances may make keeping an appointment difficult, but if your availability changes, we'd ask you to inform your Divisional Customer Service Team as soon as possible.

PROVIDING A GOOD AFTER SALES SERVICE

We pride ourselves on ensuring that both Crest Nicholson and its contractors rectify defects within an agreed timescale and that our customers are left satisfied with the result.

If you have any concerns with the service that you receive from us, please don't hesitate to contact our Customer Service Team.

We appreciate feedback from our customers, as this allows us to monitor our performance and ensures our customer service continues to improve, so that our customers are satisfied and would be happy to recommend us.

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TWO YEAR WARRANTY FAQ'S

If you have a problem and you are not clear about what action to take, please refer to the Crest Nicholson warranty FAQ's below.

Please note that the list is not exhaustive, but it covers most of the common issues that could arise.

KEY

Please contact Crest Nicholson Customer Service Team.

This is not covered by the warranty. This should be carried out as part of home owner maintenance and is the responsibility of the purchaser/home owner to resolve or maintain.

ITEM	PROBLEM	COMMENTS	WHO IS RESPONSIBLE
Appliances (Electrical)	Failure	Your appliances are covered by a manufacturer's warranty and you'll find a troubleshooting guide and details of how to contact them in your user manual and on their website.	
Carbon Monoxide Alarm	Alert	If the alarm sounds, you should leave the property. If the battery alert sounds – please check the battery, test and clean the unit. If after checking the battery there is still a fault, please contact Crest Nicholson.	
Central Heating	Failure / breakdown	Before calling, please refer to your boiler/cylinder/programmer instructions in the first instance and follow instructions to reset. Make a note of any fault codes that are displayed.	
Central Heating Boiler and Cylinder	Servicing	Annual servicing of the boiler and cylinder, along with maintaining the operating pressure is the responsibility of the home owner.	

ITEM	PROBLEM	COMMENTS	WHO IS RESPONSIBLE
Condensation and Mould	Surface damage and mould	It's important that you manage the environment within your home with adequate ventilation and heating to prevent condensation and any problems it may cause if left unmanaged, such as water damage and mould.	
Cracks	Internal / external cracks and nail pops / cracks to wood joints	Some cracking may occur as settlement occurs and materials dry out and this isn't considered to be a defect. It is something we would recommend you address as part of your routine maintenance and decoration.	
Damage	Cosmetic damage	Any cosmetic defects, such as scratches, chips or dents aren't covered by your warranty. Any damage reported at handover will be attended to by way of repair or replacement. This includes damage to internal decoration and glazing, which is visible when viewed from a 2m distance in natural daylight.	CREST NICHOLSON
Doors and Windows	Locks and hinges	Working parts require regular cleaning and lubrication to operate freely.	
Drains	Blockages	You are responsible for the drainage pipework of your home. Your drains are designed to take human waste and tissue away from your home and can be susceptible to blockages if wipes, biodegradable wipes, fats and sanitary products are deposited in them.	
Driveway	Surface water pooling	Some settlement may occur over time and with use. If that results in standing water exceeding 5mm in depth over a $1m^2$ area that remains an hour after rain has ceased, it should be reported to Crest Nicholson.	CREST NICHOLSON

ITEM	PROBLEM	COMMENTS	WHO IS RESPONSIBLE
Fencing	Loose panels / posts	Maintenance of fencing panels and posts is the responsibility of the home owner. Problems arising due to storms and high winds are not covered by the warranty.	
Floor Structures	Noisy	Some noise or creaks are normal and occur as a result of settlement and drying out of natural timbers and does not constitute a defect.	
Garage	Water ingress	Garages are not habitable spaces and may be subject to some water ingress both through single skin brickwork and at the foot of the door, particularly during driving rain. Water ingress isn't considered a defect.	
Garage Door	Locks, cables and opening action	Working parts require periodic lubrication. Refer to the manufacturer's instructions.	
Garden	Landscaping	As the home owner, you are responsible for the maintenance of the garden and its contents, including watering, aeration, addressing settlement of soil and ensuring adequate drainage is maintained.	
Garden	Lawn care	If a newly laid lawn is provided, watering and ongoing maintenance is the responsibility of the home owner.	
Gas Installation	Faulty	If you smell gas or suspect a gas leak, you MUST shut off the gas supply. Do not operate anything electrical, including light switches, leave the property immediately and call **0800 111 999**. Make sure you open all windows to ventilate the property. You should then contact Crest Nicholson.	CREST NICHOLSON

ITEM	PROBLEM	COMMENTS	WHO IS RESPONSIBLE
Grouting	Cracking	Maintenance of grouting is the responsibility of the home owner.	
Gutters and Downpipes	Blockages	Problems arising from debris in gutters (dead leaves, etc.) are the responsibility of the home owner and are not covered by the warranty.	
Kitchen Units	Door alignment	You can expect that regular use may cause door alignment to alter and you can quickly fix this at home yourself.	
Kitchen Units / Worktops	Wear and tear / delamination	Please refer to the manufacturer's care guide and ensure spillages are wiped immediately.	
Pests and Vermin	Infestation	Pest infestations in your home are not covered by your warranty and you should refer to a suitable pest control specialist.	
Roof	Defects	Contact Crest Nicholson to report a defect. However, please note that we cannot take responsibility for severe weather damage and would refer you to your insurers for damage.	CREST NICHOLSON
Silicone Sealant and Mastic (External and Internal)	Damage / failure	Maintenance of sealant will be part of your household maintenance.	

ITEM	PROBLEM	COMMENTS	WHO IS RESPONSIBLE
Structure	Defect	Contact Crest Nicholson.	CREST NICHOLSON
Telephones	Sockets	These will be wired by Crest Nicholson as standard. Contact us if there is an issue.	CREST NICHOLSON
TV	Aerial	The TV aerial is the responsibility of the home owner. Aerials are not supplied as standard and the coaxial cable is left loose in the roof space.	
Communal TV	Sockets / dish	Your apartment will be wired for service and be connected to a communal receiver. Service will be available on your subscription to a provider.	
Ventilation	Condensation / shrinkage	The home owner is responsible for ensuring adequate ventilation is maintained, as per system operating guidelines.	
Wastes Pipes and Trap	Internal Blockages	Waste pipes to showers and sinks should be maintained to ensure water flows freely. You may need to remove soap and hair residue if the discharge flow of waste water is reduced.	
Water Services	Leaking pipes and taps	Contact Crest Nicholson to report internal leaks relating to the water supply within your home.	CREST NICHOLSON
Windows	Alignment	Should alignment of windows and doors prevent closure, please contact us.	CREST NICHOLSON

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Q WHAT SHOULD I DO IF I HAVE AN EMERGENCY DEFECT OUTSIDE OF NORMAL OFFICE HOURS?

Each Divisional Customer Service telephone number is monitored 24 hours a day, 7 days a week throughout the year should you have an emergency that requires urgent attention.

An Emergency is defined as:

- Water leaks that cannot be contained and are causing damage or penetrating electrical fittings
- Loss of gas, water or electricity ensuring that the loss isn't due to a supplier issue
- Failure of a heating system between October and April
- Loss of hot water
- Loss of roof tiles which could cause further damage or allow water to penetrate electrical fittings. Please note: storm damage to be referred to home insurers
- Blocked foul water drains (excluding domestic blockages) resulting in a blocked toilet where there is only one in the home
- Ineffective locking system to doors or windows compromising safety and security.

If you smell gas call the Gas Emergency Services on 0800 111 999

Q WHAT HAPPENS IF I NEED TO REPORT A DEFECT?

You'll need to contact our Customer Service Team, who will take details from you and arrange an inspection if it's necessary. Should we need to arrange any specialist contractors to attend at your home, we may ask them to contact you directly to arrange an appointment. If you are unable to be at home yourself to allow access during the normal working day, you may need to arrange for someone else to be at home to facilitate the appointment.

Q IS SHRINKAGE COVERED BY THE WARRANTY?

Shrinkage is a common occurrence in new homes as different materials dry out at different rates and you may notice small cracks appearing on plaster walls and ceilings, especially at joints with other materials (e.g. along skirting boards and around doors/windows). The drying out process can take several months and during this time, we'd recommend that you maintain an even temperature and ventilate well to reduce the effects as much as possible.

Although the appearance of shrinkage cracks may initially cause concern, rest assured it is a normal part of the drying out process and is nothing to worry about.

Cracks can be easily filled and painted when you come to decorate your property.

Q WHAT FITTINGS SHOULD I USE FOR HANGING PICTURES/MIRRORS?

The walls inside your home are plasterboard that has been fixed to either blockwork, timber or metal stud and you should ensure that the correct fixings are used for each. Please be advised that it is always best to use a qualified tradesperson to undertake work, as they will have the tools to detect the location of plastic and metal pipework, any electrical cables and studs/pillars in the walls.

Q HOW DO I MANAGE CONDENSATION?

Condensation occurs when water vapour comes into contact with cooler surfaces in your home. This vapour can come from the drying out of your home and from normal activities such as washing and cooking as well as breathing. If condensation isn't managed well, it can sometimes cause mould growth which can cause damage to your home and belongings.

You can manage it by being aware of activities that generate moisture and ventilating vapour away, especially when cooking and washing. Maintaining an even temperature throughout your home will also help to reduce condensation.

Q WHAT SHOULD I DO IF I HAVE A PROBLEM WITH MY WHITE GOODS?

Any white goods provided by Crest Nicholson as part of your purchase are covered by the manufacturer's warranty for a minimum of two years. Please check the document provided to you on completion "Available guarantees and warranties for your home" to see whether you need to do anything to register your ownership.

Please contact the relevant manufacturer directly if you encounter any difficulties with a fitted appliance.

Q MY BOILER PRESSURE HAS DROPPED, IS THIS A DEFECT?

Occasional drops in pressure are not considered defects, and re-pressurising your heating system is considered part of your home owner maintenance.

We would recommend that you undertake a quick visual routine inspection of your boiler pressure on a monthly basis and ensure that the pressure is maintained between the manufacturers recommended pressure (usually between 1 and 1.5 bar when cold) and if you find that the system pressure has fallen, please consult your boiler user guide and follow the instructions to re-pressurise your system.

You will also need to arrange for annual servicing of your central heating system in accordance with the manufacturers recommendations.